

Incident Alert 0017. TLP Green.		Date	Breakout Scale
Title	ES-They 'Do Not Need Rest Like Humans': RT Debuts		
	AI-Generated 'Journalists'	03/07/2024	N/A

Summary

In late 2023, RT unveiled artificial “journalists” or “digital creators” who mimic the roles of journalists or news broadcasters.

According to a report from InfoEpi Lab, RT Español uses AI-Generated Journalists and does not disclose this nearly 70% of the time.

RT Espanol followers by platform 3.5 million Twitter, 17 million Facebook, 1 million Instagram, 189,000 Telegram, 3 million TikTok

Incident – When, Who did what, to say what, to whom, why?

On December 19th, 2023, RT unveiled artificial “journalists” or “digital creators” that mimic the role of journalists or news broadcasters.

In 23 reviewed videos, RT Español disclosed using these AI-generated “journalists” only 30% of the time, which can raise ethical concerns about misleading the audience. Both avatars were used to deliver biased coverage favorable to the Kremlin.

They were more likely to disclose that it was AI-generated “journalists” if the subject of the video was deemed controversial or historical.

RT Español has roughly 25 million followers across five social media platforms with which they can share these videos.

With AI-generated “journalists,” the accountability function journalists perform can be subverted—crucial aspects of journalistic integrity, a key component of journalism in democratic states.

Narrative

N/A

Impact

Reach: RT Espanol followers by platform 3.5 million Twitter, 17 million Facebook, 1 million Instagram, 189,000 Telegram, 3 million TikTok

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

T0023 Tactic: Develop Content

T0087 Tactic: Develop Content

T0009 "Create fake experts" - The avatars present in-depth reporting like an investigative journalist.

T0097 "Create personas"

T0101 Tactic: Microtarget

T0092.002 Tactic: Establish Social Assets

T0111.001 "TV"

T0111 "Traditional Media"

Recommendations

Advocate strongly for norms in journalism against AI-generated journalists.

AI can undoubtedly speed up writing processes, but there are ethical reasons why it should not replace human journalists, even if its capabilities become comparable. The crux of the issue lies not in what AI can do but in what it can never be.

A journalist's role extends beyond mere writing; it involves holding powerful individuals accountable, asking challenging questions, and conducting on-the-ground investigations. The focus on AI replacing writers often centers around its writing ability, but that should be a lesser concern.

Professionals gain credibility through years of establishing a reputation and rapport, acting on a conscience that guides them, and accumulating lived experiences. Even if AI generates content, it cannot replace the essential role that human journalists play in upholding democracy.

Newsrooms must be transparent about AI's role in their processes, primarily when it produces finished content. Ethical practice should involve telling readers how the AI models are developed, akin to how journalists list their education and experience in their profiles. This transparency helps maintain trust with the audience and clarifies the origins of the information presented.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
Link	AI, Journalism, Ethics	Video1 , 2 , 3 , 4 , Text	E. Rosalie Li (Infoepi Lab)	Article	TV, Digital News